

Washington National Cathedral

The spiritual home of the American people at the heart of the US capital

The US does not have an official or state religion, but the nearest it has to a spiritual home is the Washington National Cathedral. Technically called the Cathedral Church of St. Peter and St. Paul in the City and Diocese of Washington, this cathedral of the Episcopal Church has, from its earliest days, been a national shrine, a “house of prayer for all people,” and a place where major state events and funerals could take place.

Several years in the making

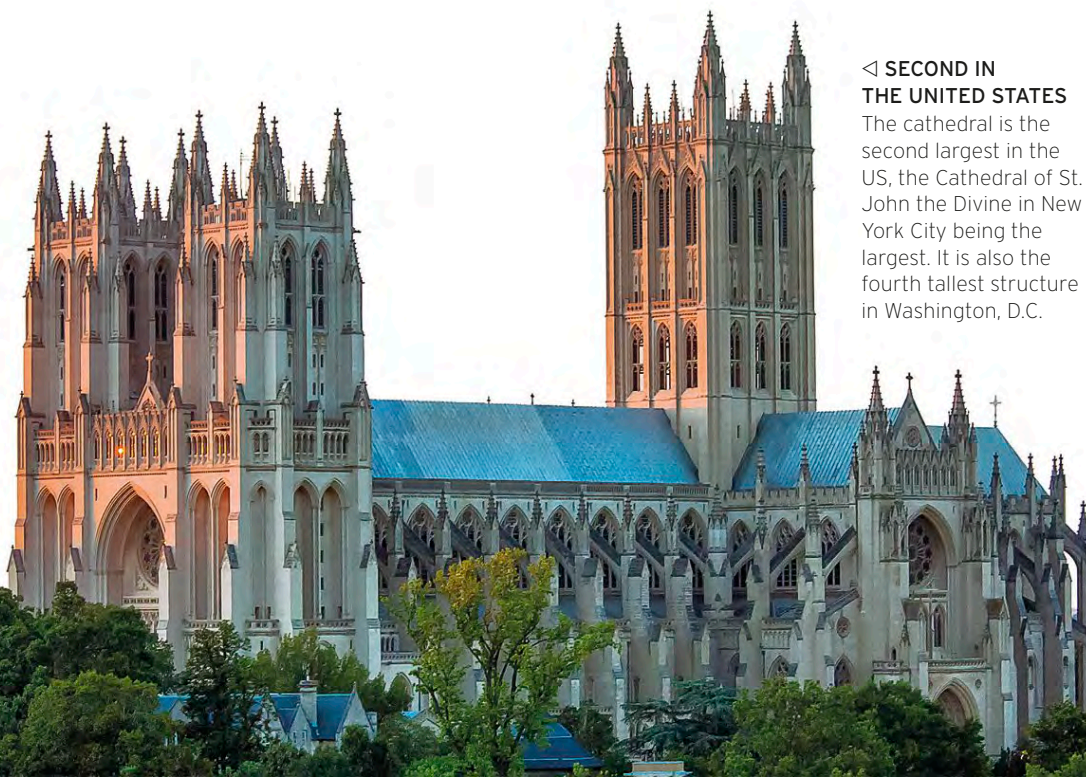
The building itself is in a Neo-Gothic style closely modeled on the English Gothic style of the late 14th century. Construction began in 1907, when President Theodore Roosevelt laid the foundation stone, and continued until 1990, when the final finial was placed in the presence of President George H. W. Bush, although decorative works continue to this day.



△ GROTESQUE CARVINGS

The Washington National Cathedral has hundreds of imaginative chimeras carved in the traditional style of cathedral grotesques.

State funerals for four postwar US presidents have been held here



◁ SECOND IN THE UNITED STATES

The cathedral is the second largest in the US, the Cathedral of St. John the Divine in New York City being the largest. It is also the fourth tallest structure in Washington, D.C.

